

OREGON STATE HOSPITAL

POLICY

SECTION 5: Human Resource Management **POLICY: 5.024**

SUBJECT: HEART Trauma Response Program

POINT PERSON: Trauma Response Coordinator

APPROVED: Sara Walker, MD  **DATE: JULY 31, 2024**
Interim Superintendent

SELECT ONE: ☐ New policy ☒ Minor/technical revision of existing policy
☐ Reaffirmation of existing policy ☐ Major revision of existing policy

I. PURPOSE AND APPLICABILITY

- A. Oregon State Hospital (OSH) recognizes that staff are a valued resource and are essential to OSH's mission of delivering high quality, recovery-oriented, compassionate, cost-effective, and respectful mental health services. OSH provides a trauma response program via the Hospital Employee's Assistance Response Team (HEART) to offer timely support to staff who have been involved in, have witnessed, or who have been affected by a traumatic incident. This policy establishes the trauma response program through HEART and provides guidance to staff for participating in or using this resource.
- B. This policy applies to all staff.

II. POLICY

- A. Participation in HEART is voluntary.
1. Any staff may request the services of a trained HEART responder for another staff who has been impacted by a traumatic event.
 2. The supervisor receiving information regarding a traumatic incident involving staff is responsible to contact HEART for support services.
 3. If a staff member may require services beyond the scope of HEART, the staff member may be referred to the Employee Assistance Program (EAP) and/or onsite counselor.

- B. If emergency medical services are necessary after a traumatic incident, staff must follow OSH policies 8.002, "Emergency Medical Care Provided by OSH," and 8.038, "Code Blue Medical Emergency".
- C. At the discretion of the Superintendent or On-Call Administrator, in consultation with the appropriate unit manager/administrator, program nurse manager, or director of nursing services, a staff member may be relieved from duty and replaced by another staff member if there is a question of a staff member's fitness for duty.
- D. Subject to minimum staffing requirements, a staff member who feels unable to perform assigned job duties may request to be relieved of assigned duties. The staff member may use "critical incident leave" or accrued leave according to applicable Department of Administrative Services (DAS), Oregon Health Authority (OHA), and OSH policies as well as applicable union contracts.
- E. Trauma responder assistance and support will be provided in a nonthreatening and confidential environment separate from any investigative process that may occur related to the traumatic incident.
 - 1. Exceptions to confidentiality will be made for communications or actions that meet criteria in OSH Policy and Procedure 7.008, "Patient Abuse or Mistreatment Allegation Reporting" and other regulations regarding abuse reporting.
 - 2. HEART responders must disclose confidential information in accordance with requirements for mandatory reporters, including:
 - a. information for a court-ordered subpoena;
 - b. indication that the impacted staff member is going to commit a crime;
 - c. warning that the impacted staff member is going to harm themselves or others.
- F. Trauma responders must receive education and training pertaining to effective, evidence-based, trauma response services. Training is coordinated and provided by the Trauma Response Coordinator in collaboration with OSH Education Services, the EAP, and other contracted service providers as necessary.
- G. OSH follows all applicable regulations, including federal and state statutes and rules; Oregon Department of Administrative Services (DAS), Shared Services, and Oregon Health Authority (OHA) policies; and relevant accreditation standards. Such regulations supersede the provisions of this policy unless this policy is more restrictive.

- H. Staff who fail to comply with this policy or related policy attachments or protocols may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

III. DEFINITIONS

- A. "Staff" includes employees, volunteers, trainees, interns, contractors, vendors, and other state employees assigned to work at Oregon State Hospital (OSH).
- B. "Traumatic incident" for the purposes of this policy means a situation or event that creates a significant risk of substantial or serious harm to the physical, mental, or emotional health; safety; or well-being of a person and may impact the person's ability to function adequately in working or personal environments. Examples of traumatic incidents may include, but are not limited to:
1. serious injury or threat of serious injury,
 2. suicide or serious suicide attempt,
 3. assault,
 4. death,
 5. sexual abuse,
 6. an event that elicits memories of past trauma.
- C. "Trauma responders" refers to volunteer staff from various disciplines throughout the hospital and Training and Support Department (TSD) who have received training specific to the HEART responder role.
- D. "Trauma Response Coordinator" means the person designated to coordinate HEART services.

IV. PROCEDURES

Procedures A Staff Responsibilities

V. RELATED OSH POLICIES AND PROTOCOLS

- 1.003 Incident Reporting
- 2.012 Sentinel Events
- 5.028 Electronic Time Management System
- 6.052 Trauma Screening
- 7.008 Patient Abuse or Mistreatment Allegation Reporting
- 8.002 Emergency Medical Care Provided by OSH

8.019. Staff Response to Alleged Criminal Acts and Contraband

8.038 Code Blue Medical Emergency

VI. REFERENCES

Joint Commission Resources, Inc. (2024). *The joint commission comprehensive accreditation manual for hospitals*. LD.03.09.01. Author.

Service Employees International Union Local 503 State of Oregon 2023 – 2025 Collective Bargaining Agreement, Contract Article 136.